SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #13 · HOLY SPIRIT

“I have committed the unpardonable sin.”

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Where it often comes from

A frightening sermon about blasphemy against the Spirit. A blasphemous or angry thought that popped into your mind and would not go away. Saying something against God in a moment of pain. A sensitive or anxious conscience that keeps checking whether you are forgiven. Intrusive, unwanted thoughts are common, especially during anxiety, and they are not the same as a settled choice of the heart.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus spoke of blasphemy against the Spirit to religious leaders who saw His work and deliberately called the Spirit’s work evil. It describes a hardened heart that rejects Christ to the end, not an unwanted thought or a moment of anger. Jesus promised that all other sins and blasphemies can be forgiven. The very fact that you are worried about this, and want God, is strong evidence that your heart is not hardened against Him.

> *“Truly I tell you, the sons of men will be forgiven all sins and blasphemies, as many as they utter. But whoever blasphemes against the Holy Spirit will never be forgiven; he is guilty of eternal sin. Jesus made this statement because they were saying, ‘He has an unclean spirit.’”* **(Mark 3:28–30)**.

Also see

> “Everyone the Father gives Me will come to Me, and the one who comes to Me I will never drive away” **(John 6:37)**.

> “If we confess our sins, He is faithful and just to forgive us our sins and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness” **(1 John 1:9)**.

> “For I am convinced that neither death nor life, neither angels nor principalities, neither the present nor the future, nor any powers, neither height nor depth, nor anything else in all creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord” **(Romans 8:38–39)**.

> “The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit” **(Psalm 34:18)**.

Common self-statements

- I’ve gone too far and God can never forgive me.
- That thought proves I blasphemed the Spirit.
- It’s too late for me.
- I keep checking, and I still don’t feel forgiven.
- God has turned His back on me forever.
- There’s no point in praying anymore.

Common logical errors

- **Emotional reasoning:** Concluding “I feel unforgiven, so I must be unforgivable.”
- **Thought–action fusion:** Treating an unwanted thought as if it were a deliberate act of the heart.
- **Catastrophizing:** Jumping to the worst possible spiritual conclusion from one moment.
- **Taking Scripture out of context:** Applying Jesus’ warning to the Pharisees to a frightened believer who wants God.

- **Disqualifying the positive:** Ignoring Jesus' promise that He will never drive away anyone who comes to Him.

Challenging questions

- Who was Jesus speaking to in Mark 3, and what were they doing?
- Do I want to be close to God? Does a hardened heart want that?
- Was my thought something I chose and treasure, or something I hate?
- What does Jesus say about everyone who comes to Him?
- Has my fear grown out of Scripture, or out of anxiety and checking?
- If I confess my sins, what does 1 John 1:9 promise?
- Would someone who truly rejected the Spirit be this troubled about it?

Truth summary

> I have not committed the unpardonable sin. Jesus warned hardened leaders who called His Spirit's work evil, not frightened believers with unwanted thoughts. My concern about this shows my heart still wants God. Jesus will never drive away anyone who comes to Him, and when I confess, He is faithful to forgive me.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Blasphemy
- Forgiveness
- Anxiety/Worry
- Thinking, Unhealthy
- Holy Spirit

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Sin
- Anxiety/Worry/Fear

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> **Overcoming Anxiety** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I have committed the unpardonable sin"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I have committed the unpardonable sin." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who was Jesus speaking to, and what were they doing?
- ☐ Does a hardened heart want to be close to God?
- ☐ Did I choose this thought, or do I hate it?
- ☐ What does Jesus promise to all who come to Him?
- ☐ Is this fear from Scripture or from anxiety?
- ☐ What does 1 John 1:9 promise me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ My worry shows my heart still wants God.
- ☐ An unwanted thought is not a hardened heart.
- ☐ Jesus will never drive away anyone who comes to Him.
- ☐ When I confess, God is faithful to forgive me.
- ☐ Nothing can separate me from the love of God in Christ.
- ☐ I do not have to keep checking; I can rest in His promise.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Mark 3:28–30**
  "Truly I tell you, the sons of men will be forgiven all sins and blasphemies, as many as they utter. But whoever blasphemes against the Holy Spirit will never be forgiven; he is guilty of eternal sin. Jesus made this statement because they were saying, 'He has an unclean spirit.'"
- [ ] **John 6:37**
  "Everyone the Father gives Me will come to Me, and the one who comes to Me I will never drive away."
- [ ] **1 John 1:9**
  "If we confess our sins, He is faithful and just to forgive us our sins and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness."
- [ ] **Romans 8:38–39**
  "For I am convinced that neither death nor life, neither angels nor principalities, neither the present nor the future, nor any powers, neither height nor depth, nor anything else in all creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord."
- [ ] **Psalm 34:18**
  "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Checking log:** Each time I feel the urge to re-check whether I am forgiven, write a mark and read John 6:37 once, instead of reviewing my thoughts.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, John 6:37 becomes: "Everyone the Father gives Me will come to Me, and when **Sarah** comes to Me I will never drive **her** away."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Forgiveness" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Read Mark 3:20–30 in full,** and write who Jesus was speaking to and what they had said about Him.
- ☐ **When the frightening thought comes, let it pass** without arguing with it, praying about it again, or asking for reassurance. Notice what happens to the anxiety.
- ☐ **Delay checking:** when you want to ask someone if you are forgiven, wait thirty minutes first, then see if you still need to.
- ☐ **Talk with a pastor or Christian counselor** about intrusive thoughts. Many believers experience them.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I have committed the unpardonable sin": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One time I let the thought pass
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I have committed the unpardonable sin.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You that Jesus will never drive away anyone who comes to Him. Help me reject the lie that I have committed the unpardonable sin. Quiet my anxious thoughts, and help me rest in Your promise instead of checking again and again. I come to You, and I trust that You receive me. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.